

Go to work, go home

Teaching guide

Describe destinations with the right phrase.

Understand the distinction

Use go to before many destinations: go to the station, go to Osaka. Common activity expressions such as go to work and go to school usually omit the article when you mean the usual activity.

Home, here, there, upstairs, and abroad can work as destination adverbs: go home, go there. Do not add to in these patterns. Go to the school can mean visiting a particular school building.

Compare the patterns

DESTINATION

We are going to the station.

Use to with the place noun.

HOME

I am going home.

Home needs no to here.

ACTIVITY

She goes to work by bus.

The expression names the daily activity.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. I am tired. I want to go ____ .

A. to home

B. home

C. at home

2. Add the missing word: We went ____ the museum.

A. at

B. to

C. in

3. Does go to the school always mean attend classes?

A. Yes. It always means being a student there.

B. No. It can mean visit the school building.

C. No. It always means working there.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. Which pair correctly describes a daily journey to work and back home?

- A. I go work at eight. I go to home at five.
- B. I go to work at eight. I go home at five.
- C. I go to work at eight. I go at home at five.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. B. home

Home is a destination adverb here.

A: Go home does not take to in this meaning.

C: At home describes a location; go home describes movement.

2. B. to

Museum is a noun naming a destination.

A: Go to names the destination; at describes location.

C: Use to for this destination after went.

3. B. No. It can mean visit the school building.

The article can highlight a particular place rather than the routine activity.

A: Someone can go to the school to visit its building without attending classes.

C: The phrase alone does not tell us the purpose of the visit.

4. B. I go to work at eight. I go home at five.

Go to work uses to; go home does not.

A: Use go to work and go home.

C: At home describes location; movement home uses go home.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-02.html

A practical teaching sequence

1. Notice (2 minutes)

Read the comparison examples with the learners. Point out the meaning and form that distinguish each pattern.

2. Choose (4 minutes)

Learners select one option for each of the three checks. Keep the answer key covered. Use the selected option's explanation rather than presenting a generic model as feedback.

3. Apply (5 minutes)

Which pair correctly describes a daily journey to work and back home?

Learners choose the response that fits this situation. All responses in this activity are multiple choice; do not replace the choices with a written-answer task.

4. Review (3 minutes)

Compare selected options with the key. Use the option-specific notes to explain why a distractor does not fit. Let learners change their selection and try again.

Scope of the answer key

Each question has one correct option among the choices shown. This does not mean that every other way to express the idea is wrong. Preserve the qualifications in the teaching notes.

Feedback criteria

Check both grammatical form and the stated situation. A correct option answers this question; four correct choices do not certify a learner's overall proficiency.